

WordPress: Addressing the Security Challenge

WordPress remains the most popular content management platform today. However, organisations very often forget to update their websites with the latest version, putting them at a security risk.



“Content is king! Content is where I expect much of the real money will be made on the internet, just as it was in broadcasting,” said Bill Gates nearly 30 years ago. Today, content is at the centre of a business’s digital transformation and the customer experience. An organisation must therefore onboard technology platforms that help manage this content, and there is a range of content management systems (CMS) that it can choose from, open source or otherwise.

There has been a lot of evolution in content management systems, be it open source or commercial software. This is one area where open source has not lost its lustre, with frameworks and platforms like WordPress, Joomla and Drupal being the most popular, among many others. Sixty-five per cent of all websites that exist today use these three platforms. That speaks for the robustness these platforms bring to all kinds of use cases across industry domains for small and large organisations. Figure 1 shows the

ease of use of the open source CMS platforms that are widely adopted.

Apart from being available for about two decades, these popular platforms have many similarities. They are all based on PHP as a programming language and use MySQL for database storage. All of them use templates and themes backed by robust developer communities that offer rich plugins, modules, and extensions to complement the features in the core platform. All the platforms have feature-rich access